



EUROPEAN COMMISSION
SECRETARIAT-GENERAL

GUIDELINES FOR STAFF ON THE USE OF GENERATIVE ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE TOOLS 3 JULY 2025

-As endorsed by the Information Management Steering Board on 3 July 2025-

1. INTRODUCTION

These guidelines are designed to help staff members ⁽¹⁾ assess the risks and limitations of generative Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools and set conditions for their safe and appropriate use in the working activities of the European Commission. The document covers both third-party tools that are publicly available on the internet, and internal tools developed and/or approved by the IT governance of the Commission ⁽²⁾.

Generative AI tools refer to systems capable of creating new content (text, images, code, etc.) in response to user prompts. Well-known external examples include General Purpose AI such as ChatGPT, Google Gemini, Claude, and others. Within the European Commission, corporate generative AI services are available to staff – for example GPT@EC for general-purpose tasks, GPT@JRC for scientific research purposes and eBriefing for drafting briefings ⁽³⁾.

It is important to explore the potential benefits of generative AI tools for professional use. However, it is equally important to be aware of associated risks. Commission-internal tools operate within secure, trusted environments which significantly reduce – but do not eliminate – the risks and limitations inherent to generative AI tools. Like any other information and communication tool used by staff in the Commission, generative AI tools – particularly online third-party ones – must only be used when appropriate and safe, and always in full compliance with the applicable terms of use.

Staff are reminded that any use of AI tools must comply with all applicable legal obligations, in particular the EU Artificial Intelligence Act (Regulation (EU) 2024/1624). This regulation introduces a risk-based framework, with specific

⁽¹⁾ These guidelines apply to all Commission staff (e.g. officials, temporary agents, and contract agents), as well as to seconded national experts, trainees, contractors, and other service providers.

⁽²⁾ This document replaces the previously published *Guidelines for Staff on the Use of Online Available Generative AI Tools* (2023). Given the evolution of the technology, the legal framework, and the increased availability of both external and internal generative AI tools, the scope and the rules of these guidelines have been revised accordingly.

⁽³⁾ For an overview of corporate AI tools in the Commission, consult [REDACTED]

requirements depending on the risk posed by an AI system. Most generative AI use-cases in the Commission are likely to fall under the limited-risk or general-purpose categories, but certain use cases – such as recruitment or decision-making affecting individuals – may be considered high-risk in the sense of the AI Act. Staff must ensure that AI is used in a way that respects fundamental rights and is fully compliant with the AI Act. For further guidance on how to determine the risk-level of your AI use-case, consult the guidelines and trainings available through the AI@EC portal.

2. RULES FOR USING GENERATIVE AI IN COMMISSION WORK

2.1. [Rule n°1] Use Commission internal AI tools as the first choice.

For any work-related task involving generative AI, **staff must use the Commission's internal tools as the default option and follow their terms and conditions**. These tools operate in controlled IT environments. External AI tools may only be considered if no suitable internal alternative is available.

2.2. [Rule n°2] Do not use non-public or personal data in external AI tools and ensure proper handling of sensitive and personal data when using internal AI tools.

Anything you write or upload into an external AI tool, as with any other external online tools in general, risks being stored and reused by the service provider, potentially exposing internal Commission information. **Never input into external AI tools any information that is not already public or any personal data ⁽⁴⁾.**

Using internal Commission tools significantly mitigates the risk of disclosing non-public information, as these tools operate within trusted environments. Some internal tools like GPT@EC and GPT@JRC offer optional settings for handling *Sensitive Non-Classified* (SNC) information ⁽⁵⁾. Other internal tools, like eTranslation, eBriefing and eReply, treat all inputs and outputs as SNC by default. However, the handling of *Classified* information is strictly prohibited in any generative AI tool, including Commission-internal ones.

Even when using internal tools, the processing of personal data must fully comply with the applicable personal data protection rules. **Staff should carefully assess whether there is a need to process any personal data** and only do so when there is a legal basis for such processing and only to the extent strictly necessary. Where personal data is processed, appropriate data protection documentation must be in place, as required. In addition, a human review of outputs is necessary to comply with the principle of accuracy and transparency regarding the use of generative AI tools. Further, it is not permitted to subject individuals to decisions which produce legal effects based solely on automated processing. Finally, it should be ensured that

⁽⁴⁾ By exception, such input could take place within a pre-authorised scientific project involving e.g. the evaluation, testing or benchmarking of AI solutions.

⁽⁵⁾ For more information on information security levels, consult [REDACTED] and the [REDACTED]

individuals can effectively exercise their rights under data protection law ⁽⁶⁾. When in doubt, services should consult their Data Protection Coordinator before initiating any processing of personal data.

2.3. [Rule n°3] Always critically assess AI outputs for accuracy and bias.

Generative AI may produce outputs that are factually incorrect, incomplete or biased – regardless of whether the tool is internal or external. **Do not rely on AI tools as authoritative sources.** Staff must always verify all AI-generated content, even when it appears coherent and confident, before using it further in Commission work. Treat AI-generated content only as an initial draft: revise, adapt, and validate it (including the sources and references mentioned in the output) before use. Staff remain fully responsible for the final result.

2.4. [Rule n°4] Be mindful of potential intellectual property rights violations and avoid directly replicating the output of a generative AI tool in public documents.

Lack of transparency on the origin of materials used for training generative AI models raises concerns related to intellectual property (IP) rights, regardless of whether the tool is internal or external. It is possible that copyright protected information has been used for training the AI model and ends up being reproduced in the output. Always **assess whether generated output might violate intellectual property rights.** For more guidance (such as for images, videos or software), see [REDACTED] and when in doubt, contact the Commission's Central IP Service ⁽⁷⁾.

Moreover, **outputs from generative AI tools should not be copy-pasted** in documents meant to be published. Exceptions can be considered if such output is based solely on documents owned by or duly licensed to the Commission (e.g. an official text translated via eTranslation). Particular caution is warranted for the drafting of legislative texts.

⁽⁶⁾ See, in particular, Art. 24 of Regulation (EU) 2018/1725.

⁽⁷⁾ [REDACTED] – on Sharepoint: [REDACTED]